

Progress Test 1 — Modules 1–4

A halfway check after Lesson 4.3. It covers the advanced future forms (future continuous, future perfect simple and continuous, the future in the past), degrees of certainty (*may well / might as well*, the jobs of *will* and *would*, continuous and perfect modals), the mandative subjunctive and unreal *were*, *as if* + past, mixed conditionals and the alternatives to *if*, inversion, cleft sentences and fronting, nominalization, reference, substitution and ellipsis, hedging and diplomatic softening, phrasal verbs, collocation, idiom and connotation, and the register shift of the Lesson 4.3 project. It tells you what to recycle in Weeks 7–13. It does not rank anyone.

 ~58 min written

+ 8 min pair speaking

Written /60 • Speaking /15 • Total /75

CEFR C1

WHY A PROGRESS TEST, AND HOW TO FRAME IT

C1 learners are usually experienced test-takers, and many are sitting this one with a university application, a professional license, or a promotion in mind. That can make them *more* anxious, not less: a high-achieving adult often hears a score as a verdict. Say it plainly: **"This is a check, not an exam. It tells me which parts of Modules 1–4 are secure and which ones we should revisit, and it shows you how much more precise your English is than it was in Week 1."** Remind the class to **skim the questions before they read or listen**, and do every *example* item together. Read the listening at a natural pace with natural contractions and weak forms (*I'd've*, *may as well*, *it was the price that*): at C1, hearing them in connected speech is part of the test, so don't over-articulate.

RUNNING CLASS 13 (90 MIN)

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer & set-up	5 min	S-S • T-S	A 3-minute "certainty dial" warmer in pairs: one partner names a future event ("the price of coffee next year"), the other answers with a point on the dial (<i>It may well...</i> , <i>It might just...</i> , <i>It can't possibly...</i>). It warms up modality without giving anything away. Go through the paper's instruction words on the board: <i>circle</i> , <i>complete</i> , <i>rewrite</i> , <i>Yes / No / Doesn't say</i> , <i>copy</i> . Hand out the paper face down ; learners write their names.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Part 1 · Listening	13 min	T-S	The whole class together. Give 30 seconds to read each section's questions first. Read each script on the teacher pages twice , with about 10 seconds between readings. Do example item 0 together first.
Parts 2–5 · written	45 min	S	Words & phrases, Grammar, Reading, and Writing, done individually. Suggest a pace on the board: Parts 2–3 about 17 minutes, Part 4 about 10, Part 5 about 18 . Walk around and clarify instructions for anyone who asks, but don't help with answers. Early finishers check their work, then read a quality long-form article of their choice (a printed op-ed works well) and note three collocations for their phrasebook. They don't help classmates with the test.
Break	5 min	—	Collect papers.
Speaking + catch-up stations	22 min	S-S · T-S	Call learners to a quiet corner in pairs for the 8-minute speaking task (cards on the teacher pages) and score with the grid. Everyone else rotates through catch-up stations : ① a "Rewrite it four ways" card game from Modules 2–3 (neutral → inversion → cleft → nominalized), ② the online lessons on a phone (🔊 Listen, then shadow the model sentences, especially Lessons 1.2 and 2.1), ③ a "blunt → diplomatic" card set from Lesson 3.3 with a partner. About 3 pairs fit in 22 minutes. With more learners, finish the speaking in the Class 14 warmer or ask a volunteer or co-teacher to run the stations.

◆ YOU NEED

- ◆ One learner paper per person (the middle section of this pack). Print it at 100% so the writing lines stay usable
- ◆ The teacher pages: listening scripts, speaking cards (cut A/B, the discussion card, and the new-identity cards), and one scoring grid per pair
- ◆ Pencils or pens, and a clock the class can see
- ◆ The answer key and rubrics:

[assessment/assessment-key.html](#)

◆ WHAT EACH PART CHECKS

- ◆ **Listening /10**: hearing fine contrasts in connected speech (modality, inversion, clefts, the tactful future continuous), a short briefing, and diplomatic disagreement with understatement
- ◆ **Words & phrases /10**: collocation and phrasal verbs (4.1–4.2), then connotation and register (4.1–4.2)
- ◆ **Grammar /20**: 10 circle items + 10 rewrites (inversion, clefts, nominalization, hedging, the subjunctive, *but for*, diplomatic distancing)
- ◆ **Reading /10**: a magazine column, "Quiet Mornings", read for detail, reference, hedging, understatement, and the writer's position
- ◆ **Writing /10**: a short formal recommendation to a board (130–160 words)

- ◆ **Speaking /15:** projections and what-ifs, a discussion that reaches a compromise, and a quick register shift (pairs)

LITERACY-ADAPTED VERSION (LEARNERS WHOSE READING AND WRITING LAG BEHIND THEIR SPEAKING)

At C1 this is less common, but you may have a learner whose English was built largely by ear at work, or who has a diagnosed reading difficulty such as dyslexia. Use the **same paper** and change how it is done, not what it tests. **Read every instruction and item aloud**, one at a time, and enlarge the paper if you can. In **Parts 2–3**, read the choices aloud and accept a spoken answer; for the rewrites (11–20), let the learner **say** the new sentence and score what they say. Do **Part 4** orally: read the column aloud twice and ask the questions. In **Part 5**, the learner may **dictate** the recommendation while you scribe; score its content, organization, register, and language, not the handwriting or spelling. Give extra time, or split the paper over two sittings. Write **"Adapted"** at the top and note what changed. Report these learners' **listening and speaking** as the main evidence. A literacy gap is not a language gap, and the key explains how to act on it.

PERSONAL INFORMATION AND OPINIONS ARE ALWAYS OPTIONAL

The speaking task asks about plans, regrets, and turning points; the discussion and the writing ask for a position. Learners can answer with a **"new identity"** (the cards on the teacher pages) or an invented story, and in the discussion and the recommendation they may argue an **assigned side** that isn't their own view. Say this before the test starts: **"Real or imagined, your side or the other side: it makes no difference. I'm scoring the English, not your life or your opinions."** Never ask follow-up questions about home country, family members who are absent, or immigration status.

My Halfway Check

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____



Listen



Read



Circle



Write



Rewrite



Speak

Skim the questions **before** you listen or read, and look at each example first. If an instruction isn't clear, just ask: "Could you clarify what this part is asking for?"



Part 1 · Listening

___ / 10



A. Listen. Circle the sentence you hear.

0 e.g.

By June, I'll have finished the course.

By June, I'll be finishing the course.

1

We may well start without him.

We may as well start without him.

2

If I'd known, I'd have called you.

Had I known, I'd have called you.

3

What worried us was the price.

It was the price that worried us.

4

Will you use the car tonight?

Will you be using the car tonight?



B. Listen to Dr. Ortiz, the director of a community health clinic, speaking to volunteers. Circle the correct answer.

5

By next spring, the clinic will have been open for ...

five years

ten years

fifteen years

6

About how many patients miss weekday appointments because of work?

a quarter

a third

half

7 How certain is Dr. Ortiz that Saturday opening will help?

a) She is sure it will solve the problem.

b) She thinks it is quite likely to help, but she can't promise it.

c) She doubts it will make much difference.

 **C. Listen to two volunteers, Amara and Josh, discussing the plan. Circle the correct answer.**

8 Who has doubts about the timing of the plan? ☐ Amara ☐ Josh ☐ Both

9 Amara says, "It's not the worst plan I've heard." She means ...

a) It's a terrible plan.

b) It's a reasonable plan, but she still has some reservations.

c) It's the best plan anyone has suggested.

10 Who wants to raise the pharmacy issue at the next meeting? ☐ Amara ☐ Josh ☐ Both



Part 2 · Words & Phrases

___ / 10



A. Complete each sentence with a word from the box. Use each word once. There is 1 extra word.



deeply highly meet put raise strongly

0 e.g. She made a very **strong** argument for the change.

- 1 The whole team is _____ concerned about the new schedule.
- 2 It is _____ unlikely that the contract will be signed before Friday.
- 3 Unless we hire more staff, we won't _____ the deadline.
- 4 Before we finish, I'd like to _____ an issue about parking.
- 5 I honestly don't know how you _____ up with that noise every day.



B. Circle the word that fits the context. Think about connotation (positive or negative) and register (formal or informal).

- 6 (*a formal report*) The department will the complaint.
- 7 (*praising a friend*) You're so . You never waste a cent.
- 8 (*complimenting a colleague*) You came across as really in the interview.
- 9 (*a formal email*) We regret that we will have to the launch.
- 10 (*a warning to drivers*) The intersection is for accidents.



A. Circle the correct word or words.

- 0 e.g. This time tomorrow, I **will be flying** ☐ will have flown over the Atlantic.
- 1 By next June, I ☐ will be working ☐ will have been working ☐ have been working here for ten years.
- 2 The last bus has gone, so we ☐ may well ☐ might as well ☐ must take a taxi.
- 3 When I was a child, I ☐ would have ☐ used to have ☐ was having a dog called Max.
- 4 The regulations require that every visitor ☐ wear ☐ wears ☐ to wear a badge.
- 5 He talks about the project as if he ☐ had designed ☐ has designed ☐ designs it himself, but he only joined last month.
- 6 If I ☐ took ☐ had taken ☐ would take that job in Denver, I'd be living there now.
- 7 Take a charger ☐ if ☐ in case ☐ unless your battery runs low on the trip.
- 8 Rarely ☐ she makes ☐ does she make ☐ does she makes a mistake in her reports.
- 9 What surprised everyone ☐ is ☐ was ☐ were how quickly she adapted.
- 10 "Will it rain during the ceremony?" — "I hope ☐ not ☐ no ☐ don't."



B. Rewrite each sentence, starting with the words given. Keep the same meaning.

- 11 I had never seen such a well-organized conference.
Never _____
- 12 If you should need any help, please call the front desk.
Should _____
- 13 Her calm under pressure impressed the panel. (*spotlight "her calm under pressure"*)
It was _____

14 We need a clear timeline more than anything.

What _____

15 The company expanded rapidly, and this reduced its costs.

The company's rapid _____

16 If you hadn't helped me, I would have missed the deadline.

But for _____

17 The demand was so great that the website crashed.

So great _____

18 The manager said Tom must attend the training.

The manager insisted that Tom _____

19 "Send me the file today." *(make the request diplomatic)*

I was wondering _____

20 "This study proves that flexible hours increase productivity." *(hedge it for an academic essay: keep "suggests" and add one more hedging word)*

This study suggests that _____



Skim the questions first. Then read the column.

Quiet Mornings: Should the Office Go Silent Until Noon?

Last spring, a mid-sized software company in Portland did something many of its employees had long wished for: it banned internal meetings before noon. Staff were told that mornings would be reserved for "deep work" (writing, coding, planning) and that anything urgent should be handled by message. Twelve months on, the results are, by most accounts, encouraging.

According to the company's own survey, 71 percent of employees say they now finish complex tasks faster, and the number of evening emails has fallen by almost a third. This, the company argues, is evidence that the policy has reduced stress as well as saved time. It may well have done so; however, a survey of a single company, carried out by that company, can hardly be considered conclusive.

Not everyone has welcomed the change. Customer-facing teams, in particular, report that clients who call in the morning are often left waiting. "I'm not entirely convinced it works for us," one account manager admitted, choosing her words carefully. Others worry that the rule simply pushes meetings into the afternoon, where they now crowd together. The complaints so far may be only the tip of the iceberg: it is too early to know whether collaboration will suffer in the long run.

What the experiment does suggest is that many meetings were never necessary in the first place. Had managers asked "Does this need to be a meeting?" more often, perhaps no rule would have been needed at all. Quiet mornings are unlikely to suit every organization, but they do raise a question worth asking in any workplace: how much of our working day do we actually control?



A. Circle Yes, No, or Doesn't say.

0

The company banned internal meetings before noon.

Yes

No

Doesn't say

1

Staff could still deal with urgent matters in the morning.

Yes

No

Doesn't say

2	More than two thirds of employees say they finish complex tasks faster.	Yes	No	Doesn't say
3	The survey was carried out by an independent research firm.	Yes	No	Doesn't say
4	The company has lost clients because of the new rule.	Yes	No	Doesn't say
5	The writer believes quiet mornings would work well in any organization.	Yes	No	Doesn't say



B. Answer the questions.

- 6 In paragraph 2, what does "This" refer to?
-
- 7 Copy **one** phrase from paragraph 2 that shows the writer is cautious about the company's claim.
-
- 8 The account manager says, "I'm not entirely convinced it works for us." What does she really mean?
-
- 9 What does "**the tip of the iceberg**" mean in paragraph 3?
-
- 10 Circle the best summary of the writer's position.
- a) Every company should adopt quiet mornings as soon as possible.
- b) The idea looks promising, but the evidence is limited and it may not suit every workplace.
- c) The policy has clearly failed and should be abandoned.



Write a formal recommendation. (130–160 words)

Your community center's board is deciding whether to **replace its printed monthly newsletter with an email-only version**. Write to the board and recommend **one** option. You may recommend either option. It doesn't have to be your personal view.

- State your **purpose** in the first sentence.
- Make your recommendation with a **formal structure** such as *I recommend that...* / *It is essential that...*
- Include at least **one hedged claim** and **one conditional** (a mixed or inverted conditional, or *provided that / unless / in case*).
- **Acknowledge the other side** diplomatically, then answer it. Close formally.

I am writing to recommend that ...

It is essential that ... be ...

This may well ...

There is some evidence that ...

Admittedly, ... That said, ...

Provided that ...

Were the board to ..., ...

Should you require further information, ...

Sincerely,

[illegible]

Finished. Well done! Now reread your answers, especially the rewrites.

FOR THE TEACHER	1 LISTENING	2 WORDS	3 GRAMMAR	4 READING	5 WRITING	WRITTEN	SPEAKING	TOTAL
Score	/10	/10	/20	/10	/10	/60	/15	/75

PART 1 · LISTENING SCRIPTS

Give 30 seconds to read the questions for each section. Read each script **twice** at a natural pace, with a pause of about 10 seconds between readings. Say the item number first ("Number one"). Don't mouth the answer or point. In Part A, say the sentence **once per reading**, with natural weak forms and contractions: *may as well* runs together as /meɪəzwel/, and *Had I known* keeps a full, stressed *Had*. The contrast is the test. For Part C, change your voice or position for each speaker, or read it with a colleague.

◆ A · CIRCLE THE SENTENCE YOU HEAR

READ ALOUD

Example, number zero: **By June, I'll have finished the course.** (Show the circle on the first sentence.)

Number 1: **We may as well start without him.**

Number 2: **Had I known, I'd have called you.**

Number 3: **It was the price that worried us.**

Number 4: **Will you be using the car tonight?**

◆ B · DR. ORTIZ (READ THE WHOLE BRIEFING TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE TO CIRCLE)

READ ALOUD

Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming. As many of you know, by next spring this clinic will have been serving the east side for **ten years**, and I'd like us to mark that by trying something new. We're proposing that the clinic open on Saturday mornings, from nine until one. Our own figures suggest that a large number of patients, **roughly a third**, miss weekday appointments because of work. Saturday hours **may well reduce that number considerably, though I should stress that this is a projection, not a promise.** The board has asked that the trial be limited to three months, which I think is sensible. Now, I won't pretend there aren't challenges. Staffing is the obvious one. Had we not received a small grant last month, we couldn't even consider it. So what I'm asking tonight is simple: if you could commit to two Saturdays over the trial, please put your name on the sheet by the door.

◆ C · AMARA AND JOSH (READ THE WHOLE DIALOGUE TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE)

Amara: So, what did you make of the Saturday proposal?

Josh: Honestly? I think it's a great idea. If we'd done this years ago, we'd have far fewer missed appointments now.

Amara: I see what you mean, though I'm **not entirely convinced the timing is right**. We're already short-staffed, and I'd hate to see people burn out.

Josh: That's fair. But she's only asking for two Saturdays each, and it's just a trial.

Amara: True. I **suppose it's not the worst plan I've heard**. What worries me is the pharmacy. It's closed on weekends, isn't it?

Josh: Hmm, good point. I hadn't thought of that. Should the pharmacy stay closed, patients would have to come back on Monday anyway.

Amara: Exactly. So I'd **suggest we raise it at the next meeting**, before anyone signs up.

Josh: Agreed. **Let's bring it up together**.

PAIR SPEAKING TASK · 8 MINUTES

Two learners sit with you. Give Card A to one and Card B to the other. Give them **one minute** to read the cards silently, then check the instructions:

SAY: *In Part 1, do you just answer, or do you ask a follow-up question too? (Both.) Short answers or developed ones? (Developed: reasons, detail, and how sure you are.) In Part 2, do you have to argue your real opinion? (No. You can take the side on the card.) What do you need to reach by the end? (A compromise.) Real life or imagined? (Either is fine.)*

Part 1 (about 3 minutes): they ask and answer the card questions, which cover projections, past plans, habits, and what-ifs. Encourage one real follow-up each. **Part 2** (about 4 minutes): give them the **discussion card**. They discuss the proposal, hedge their claims, disagree diplomatically (*acknowledge* → *soften* → *challenge*), and work toward a compromise. If a pair doesn't want to choose sides, assign them: Student A argues *for*, Student B *against*. **Part 3** (about 1 minute): ask each learner to give their conclusion **twice**, once "as if to a committee" and once "as if to a friend over coffee." Listen for vocabulary, grammar, and structure shifting *together* (*I would suggest that we trial... → Let's just try it for a month*). Step in only to restart a stuck pair ("Now ask your next question"). Don't correct during the task. Score each learner on the grid, using the rubric in the key. **Mixed-level pairs:** score each person on what *they* did, not on the pair's result.

CARD A • STUDENT A

 Part 1 • Ask your partner

- 1 Pick a point five years from now. Where do you think you'll be, and what will you have achieved by then? How sure are you?
- 2 Tell me about a plan you once had that didn't work out. What were you going to do, and what happened instead?
- 3 Describe something you would always do at a certain time in your life (a routine, a ritual, a habit).
- 4 Is there a decision you'd make differently? How would your life be different now if you had?
- 5 Answer your partner's questions. Develop each answer, and show how certain you are.

DISCUSSION CARD • BOTH STUDENTS

 Part 2 • The proposal

"Our workplace should replace the weekly all-staff meeting with a short written update." Discuss it for about 4 minutes.

- ◆ Give at least **two reasons** for your side, and **hedge** at least one claim: *This may well...*, *There's some evidence that...*
- ◆ Disagree **diplomatically**: *I take your point, but I'm not sure...* • *I see it slightly differently.*
- ◆ Use at least one **conditional**: *If we'd...*, *we'd be...* • *Provided that...* • *Were we to...*
- ◆ **Reach a compromise** at the end. No preference? Student A argues **for**, Student B **against**.

CARD B • STUDENT B

 Part 1 • Ask your partner

- 1 What do you think you'll be doing this time next year? What will you have been doing longest by then?
- 2 Think of something puzzling at work or in your neighborhood. What might have happened? What must or can't be true?
- 3 If it weren't for one person or one lucky break, where would you be now?
- 4 What's something you've had to learn to put up with? How did you get used to it?
- 5 Answer your partner's questions. Develop each answer, and show how certain you are.

NEW IDENTITY CARDS (OPTIONAL)

 Sam Okoye

In five years: running a small accounting practice • Once was going to study architecture, but the tuition went up • Always used to swim before work • Would now choose a different first job • Has learned to put up with a long commute

 Lina Haddad

This time next year: finishing a nursing degree, will have been working night shifts for three years • Puzzle: the office printer keeps "losing" jobs (someone must have changed the settings) • If it weren't for a neighbor's advice, would never have applied

Stretch (for a pair who finishes early): "Some people say that meetings are where decisions go to die. Is that fair?" Listen for inversion or a cleft used for effect (*What really slows us down is...*, *Rarely does a meeting...*) and for a hedge that is precise rather than vague. **Support**: a learner may read the question from the card, which is fine. Score the

answers and the discussion as normal. **Dominant speaker?** Turn to the quieter learner: "And where do you stand on that?" If it continues, say "Let's hear from [name] first this time" and note it under Interaction. Don't lower the quieter learner's score because they got fewer chances.

SPEAKING SCORING GRID ---

Score each criterion 0–3: 0 = no response · 1 = Not yet C1 · 2 = C1 · 3 = C1+ (strong). The descriptors are in the assessment key. Total /15.

Learner A: _____ Learner B: _____ Date: _____

CRITERION	WHAT TO LISTEN FOR	A (0–3)	B (0–3)
Task & coherence	Developed answers that place events precisely in time; a position in the discussion with reasons and a qualification; a compromise reached; two clearly different versions of the conclusion in Part 3		
Range & register	Future perfect and continuous, the certainty dial (<i>may well, might just, can't have</i>), mixed conditionals or <i>if</i> -alternatives, a cleft or inversion for emphasis, strong collocations; a real register shift in Part 3		
Accuracy	Aspect with <i>by / by the time</i> ; modal + <i>have</i> + past participle; <i>would</i> for actions, not states; mixed-conditional time logic; <i>do</i> -support after a fronted negative; phrasal-verb object position		
Interaction	A real follow-up question; acknowledges before challenging; softens without hiding the message; invites the partner's view; builds toward the compromise		
Pronunciation & fluency	Even tempo with few long silences; weak forms and linking (<i>I'd've, may as well</i>); stress on new or contrasted information; a fall-rise for polite reservation		
Total /15 · one thing that went well · one next step			

AFTER THE TEST: CLOSE THE LOOP IN WEEK 7

Score the papers before Class 14 with the key. Add up each **section** across the class, because the weakest section tells you what to recycle. Warmers in Classes 14–19 are a good place for it: for example, a 5-minute "Front it and flip it" relay (neutral → inversion) if rewrites 11–12 and 17 were weak, or a "Decide the time of each half" board race if items 6 and 16 were weak. Nominalization (rewrite 15) links naturally to Module 5's participle clauses and academic vocabulary, so recycle it there. Give each learner their paper back with **one thing they did well and one thing to refine**, plus the online lesson that practices it. The key has a class analysis and feedback phrases.